

EP Officials See Lubbock Recovery From Tornado

By GEORGE KINSINGER

Officials of the Lubbock, Tex., Chamber of Commerce and Texas Tech University Tuesday extended a warm and hospitable welcome to an El Paso delegation of City officials and members of the Sports Development Committee of the now disbanded Mayor's Council for Social Action who visited the Panhandle metropolis to learn first hand how that city has rebounded from a disastrous tornado that ruck last May.

After viewing the remaining signs of devastation that cut a wide swath through much of Lubbock, the group visited the Municipal Center where City Manager Bill Blackwell, Mayor Pro Tem Leaton Rigsby and planning staff members discussed a \$13 million disaster-recovery bond issue voted in August.

Largest item in the bond proposition was a \$7.8 million civic center to be built in one of the hardest hit areas where structure after structure was leveled to its foundation. Other successful bond proposals included a new library, a parks and recreation issue and \$2.8 for the Canon Lakes project, a series of eight connected reservoirs along Yellow House Canyon, a natural draw extending through the city.

The lakes, from 10,000 to 17,000 acres in size, would be filled by the area's plentiful rainfall and replenished by

thrice-threatened sewage effluent. Total eventual cost, including land acquisition and construction of a tertiary treatment plant, is estimated at approximately \$23 million.

The lakes, in addition to conserving potable water resources, would open a vast recreation area for fishing, boating and other water sports. The miles of shore line would provide for parks, golf course, recreation areas, tourist motels and both public and private open space development, with state and federal grant assistance.

The El Paso delegation included Mayor Pro Tem Sal Berroteran, and fellow aldermen Clinton Wolf and Tony Petry, Parks Superintendent Dale Tate, Administrative Assistant Tom Duran, Planning Director Jonathan Cunningham, Parks Board Chairman L. H. (Barney) Koogler, former Mayor Judson F. Williams, and Sports Development Committee members Andy Cohen, John Phelan, Bill Green, the Rev. Harland Irvin Jr., Clyde Wafer, Lawrence Welsch, and Mrs. Robert Suddarth, and Gary Meyers, president of El Paso Zoological Society.

Mayor Peter de Wetter, suffering from a touch of a virus, was unable to attend and was represented by his executive assistant, Oliver Goodman. The group was joined in Lubbock by Fritz Lannun, an aide to Gov. Preston Smith, in charge of the Outdoor Recreation Program.

The trip was jointly financed by the City, Koogler and El Paso Sportsmen Association.

The delegation visited the Municipal Garden and Arts Center and was told by Mrs. Georgia Ruth Booker, director, that the center was used by more than 110,000 persons a year and was the hub of community cultural activities. The center on an 80-acre site includes an arboretum, Japanese garden and beautifully landscaped grounds.

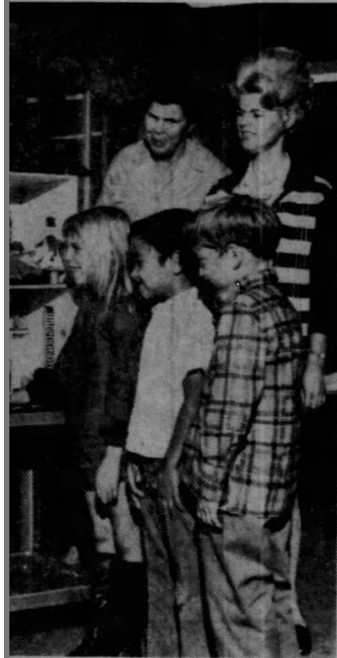
After touring the expansive Texas Tech campus under the guidance of Dr. John Kitchen, they viewed a presentation of studies made by graduate students of the Department of Parks Administration, Economics and History, headed by Dr. Elo J. Urbanovsky, concerning recreational development of the huge Amistad reservoir on the Lower Rio Grande and of arid land in West Texas.

At lunch in the Student Union they were welcomed by Chamber of Commerce President Wayne Finnell and by Dr. Grover Murray, president of Texas Tech. Response was made by Berroteran, who thanked all concerned for their warm hospitality.

The delegation also visited the football stadium to inspect the artificial turf laid at a cost of \$300,000, before embarking for flight home.

Primary purpose of the one-day trip, other than an exchange of mutual good will, was to acquaint the delegation with what other Texas cities are doing in the way of capital improvements, particularly in the area of parks and recreation development.

El Paso plans a large capital improvement program in the future, but Mayor de Wetter has indicated no City bond issues are planned for at least another 12 months.



and 2. Mrs. Ralph Clayton, left, president of El Paso County Medical Auxiliary, points out a feature of the display to first graders Laurie Sutton, Tony Kromeens, center, and Steve LaFrance. Mrs. Curtis Lyman, right, chairman of the Auxiliary's Safety Committee, looks on with Mrs. J. F. Smith, first grade teacher.